

Pre-Engagement Questionnaire

Perception Audit — Goodspell

Complete this form in writing, before the discovery session. There are no right or wrong answers — only honest ones and facades. The former are useful. The latter are not. Allocate real time to this form. Do not fill it out between meetings.

Section 1 — Business Reality

1. Describe what your business does in no more than 3 sentences. Do not use marketing language. Write it as you would explain it to an intelligent friend who doesn't know your industry.
2. What have you built in the last 3–5 years that does not appear anywhere in your public presence?
3. What are the 3 concrete results you have delivered to clients — not service categories, but real outcomes?
4. Why are you difficult to replace? What would a client lose if they went to someone else?
5. What types of clients do you serve best — where do you deliver best, where does the relationship work most naturally?

Section 2 — Current Public Presence

1. How would you describe your current public presence in 2–3 words? Not how it should be — how it is now.
2. When a potential client looks you up online before the first meeting, what do you think they find? What impression do they form?
3. Has there ever been a moment when you felt your public presence cost you an opportunity? Describe the specific situation.
4. What do current clients say about you when they recommend you to others? If you know the exact words — write them down.
5. What is missing from your public presence that you believe should be there?

Section 3 — Real Tensions

1. What is the conversation you have most often that shouldn't be necessary — the explanation you give repeatedly, even though you shouldn't have to?

2. Are there clients you have turned away or who are not a good fit for you? What differentiates them from the right fit?
3. If your public presence perfectly reflected the reality of your business, what would be concretely different — in the type of clients who contact you, in pricing conversations, in how you are perceived in the market?
4. What has stopped you from solving this problem so far?

Section 4 — Decision Context

1. Why now? What has changed in your business or in the market that makes this problem more urgent than it was 12 months ago?
2. Who else in your business should know you are doing this audit? Why or why not?

Submit completed responses at least 48 hours before the discovery session.